

# YouTube Channel Manager

Executable plan for a solo operator in Nevada | 11 September 2026

One licensed professional records for 45 to 60 minutes, once a month. You turn that hour into three episodes, eight Shorts and tested titles and thumbnails, route every item through their compliance reviewer, and publish nothing without written sign-off. **You are selling the compliance handling, not the video editing.**

## THE NUMBERS

### What this is worth and what it costs

|                |                               |                 |                           |
|----------------|-------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------|
| Startup cash   | \$59 - 124                    | Work per client | 16 - 22 h / month         |
| Monthly tools  | \$112 - 156, plan on \$125    | Ceiling         | 2 clients at 10 - 15 h/wk |
| Entry product  | A/B pack, \$150 - 300         | First dollar    | 6 - 10 weeks              |
| Retainer       | \$800/mo (band \$600 - 1,000) | First retainer  | 2 - 4 months              |
| Month 6 target | \$1,600 gross, two clients    | Effective rate  | \$26 - 34 / hour          |

#### Assumptions this plan makes about you

**You have never edited video.** Months 1 and 2 use the top of every hour band. If you can already cut video, expect the low end and a third client becomes possible.

**You have a day job.** Every sales call is scheduled in the 6:00 to 8:30am window explained in section 5. If your days are free, ignore that constraint and send more.

**Under \$500, staged.** Nothing is bought before the revenue that justifies it.

## SECTION 1

### Nevada setup - do this first, one evening

| Item                          | What to do                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Cost                      |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>State business license</b> | Nevada requires one even for sole proprietors. But a home-based business earning under two thirds of the state average wage files a <b>Notice of Exemption</b> instead. File it with the Secretary of State. Look up the current threshold at Nevada's taxable wage base. | <b>\$0</b><br>vs \$200/yr |
| <b>Do not form an LLC</b>     | Nevada is among the most expensive: \$425 in year one (\$75 articles, \$150 initial list, \$200 business license) and \$350 every year after. Revisit once you clear about \$2,000/month.                                                                                 | <b>\$0</b><br>deferred    |
| <b>EIN</b>                    | Free from the IRS, about 15 minutes online. Get one so clients never need your Social Security number on a 1099.                                                                                                                                                          | <b>\$0</b>                |

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                            |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>DBA</b>          | Only if you want to trade under a business name rather than your own. County clerk, valid five years. Clark County is mail or in person, there is no online filing.                                                                                     | <b>\$25</b><br>optional    |
| <b>Bank account</b> | Separate from personal from day one. Open a second account and move 25 to 30% of every payment into it for tax.                                                                                                                                         | <b>\$0</b>                 |
| <b>Sales tax</b>    | Nothing to do. Nevada exempts digital products including audio-visual works, and most services. No registration, no collection, nothing to add to an invoice.                                                                                           | <b>none</b>                |
| <b>Income tax</b>   | Nevada has none. Federal only. Self-employment tax is 15.3% on net earnings above \$400. Pay quarterly estimates if you will owe \$1,000 or more. Q4 2026 is due <b>15 January 2027</b> , or file the whole return by 31 January and skip that payment. | <b>25-30%</b><br>set aside |
| <b>Insurance</b>    | Not yet. Errors and omissions cover runs about \$34/month, or \$405 a year, for freelance video work, and from \$129 a year with a specialist carrier. Buy it when a client contract asks for it, or at your second client.                             | <b>\$0</b><br>deferred     |

### Recording consent - the one that can actually hurt you

Nevada requires **all-party consent for phone and video calls** (NRS 200.620). The state supreme court extended it to cell calls and texts. Violating it is a category D felony.

Your entire business is recorded video calls. Two things, every time:

1. Say it out loud and get it on the recording: *"Before we start, I'm recording this call for production. Is that okay with you?"* Wait for an audible yes.
2. Put the written consent clause in the contract, for every client, in every state.

---

## SECTION 2

### Tools and what they cost

#### Month 0 - setup only

| Tool                     | Cost              | Why this tier                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Descript Hobbyist        | \$24              | The free tier caps at 60 media minutes with watermarked exports, so it cannot hold your two portfolio webinars. |
| Claude Pro               | \$20              | All six production prompts live here.                                                                           |
| OpusClip Free or Starter | \$0 - 15          | Free is watermarked; trim samples in CapCut instead.                                                            |
| Canva Free               | \$0               | Enough for sample thumbnails.                                                                                   |
| Domain and one-page site | \$15 - 25         | Also needs a privacy page and support email, both required later to publish the analytics consent screen.       |
| Portfolio footage        | \$0               | Public-domain federal recordings. See section 4.                                                                |
| <b>Total</b>             | <b>\$59 - 124</b> | <b>Budget \$150. The remainder funds the step up to paid tiers in your first client month.</b>                  |

#### Steady state - once a client is paying

| Tool             | Cost               | The limit that bites                                                                                                                  |
|------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Descript Creator | \$35               | 30 media hours a month with <b>no rollover</b> , and every upload counts. Upload one clean master per recording, not every re-export. |
| OpusClip Pro     | \$29               | 300 credits, one per source minute. Re-running a recording after the client changes their mind spends them again.                     |
| Canva Pro        | \$18               | Monthly caps on AI features.                                                                                                          |
| Claude Pro       | \$20               | Rolling usage windows; a long transcript can hit one.                                                                                 |
| n8n              | \$0 - 24           | Free self-hosted, \$24 cloud. Not needed until month 2.                                                                               |
| Top-ups and fees | \$10 - 30          | Descript overage plus payment processing.                                                                                             |
| <b>Total</b>     | <b>\$112 - 156</b> | <b>Plan on \$125.</b>                                                                                                                 |

Confirm every price at checkout. All of these came from third-party guides in 2026, not from the vendors' own pages.

---

## SECTION 3

### Setup - two weeks, not one

Be honest about this: setup is **25 to 30 hours of work**. On a 10 to 15 hour week that is two calendar weeks, and your first emails go out at the end of the second. Anyone who tells you it is a one-week sprint is not counting the portfolio.

#### Week 1 - the paperwork and the list

| Task                                                                                                                                                                                    | Hours | Done when               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------|
| Nevada exemption filing, EIN, bank account                                                                                                                                              | 2     | All three confirmed     |
| Domain, mailbox, SPF, DKIM and DMARC set, warm-up started                                                                                                                               | 2     | Mail tester passes      |
| Build the prospect sheet. Search YouTube for retirement-planning webinars, then verify each firm in the SEC adviser search (IAPD) and confirm it is <b>not</b> broker-dealer affiliated | 4     | 45 qualified rows       |
| Write the two compliance checklists: the SEC Marketing Rule for advisers, and ABA Model Rules 7.1 and 7.2 plus the Nevada bar rule for law firms                                        | 2     | Two one-page checklists |

## Week 2 - the portfolio and the first send

| Task                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Hours | Done when              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------------------------|
| Portfolio sample 1: re-cut a public-domain IRS or Social Security Administration video into one 10-minute episode, three Shorts and three thumbnails. Label it "sample re-edit, not a client". <b>Log your hours per step.</b> | 6 - 8 | Sample set 1 live      |
| Portfolio sample 2: the same for a legal sample, from a federal legal-education recording                                                                                                                                      | 5 - 6 | Sample set 2 live      |
| One-page site with both samples, a privacy page and a support email                                                                                                                                                            | 2     | Site live              |
| Contract, approval form, six-folder client template, payments and e-signature                                                                                                                                                  | 3     | Ready to sign a client |
| <b>Send the first 15 emails</b> from your aged personal address, never the four-day-old business mailbox. Ten connection notes.                                                                                                | 2     | 25 touches out         |

### The checkpoint that decides whether you can sell this yet

Compare the hours you logged on the two samples against **8 to 11 hours**. Two samples are half a client-month, so that is the target.

If you spent 20 hours, your real per-client number is 32 to 40 and the economics do not work at \$800. Keep practising on public-domain footage before you sell anything.

---

## SECTION 4

### Portfolio - what to cut when you have no clients

Works of the United States federal government carry no copyright, so you can legally re-cut them into samples. Use an IRS Video Portal webinar or a Social Security Administration retirement video for the financial sample, and a federal legal-education recording for the legal one.

- **Strip any third-party footage or music** embedded in the recording. Government videos routinely contain material the copyright exemption does not cover.
- **Never imply the agency endorses you.**
- **Label both** "sample re-edit, not a client", on the page and in the file name.

---

## SECTION 5

### Getting clients

#### Who to approach, and who to skip

| Target                                                                                                                                                        | Skip                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fee-only registered investment advisers who already run a webinar or podcast and upload to YouTube less than once a month. Estate and elder-law firms second. | Broker-dealer affiliated advisers (every item needs principal pre-approval). Florida and Texas law firms (per-advertisement filing fees). Compliance-only accounting shops. |

#### The 6am rule - how this works around a day job

You are on Pacific time. East Coast advisers are at their desks from **6:00am your time**. That is your sales window: 6:00 to 8:30am, plus your lunch hour, which is mid-afternoon for them.

This is the single reason a Nevada operator with a job can sell to this market at all.

#### The arithmetic

| Touches per week     | Reply rate | One A/B pack        | One retainer          |
|----------------------|------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| 25 - 30 personalised | 2 - 4%     | per 50 - 75 touches | per 150 - 300 touches |

#### The first email

The observation in the first line is the whole message. Financial services has the lowest reply rate of any industry, so a generic opener is wasted volume.

Subject: Your Roth conversion video

[First name],

Your "[video title]" from [month] has [N] views and the title is the only thing on the page that does not say what it is about: it reads "[current title]". The moment at [mm:ss] where you explain [specific point] is the hook, and it is not on the thumbnail.

I run YouTube packaging and channel operations for fee-only RIAs. For \$200 I would set up a title-and-thumbnail test on that one video using YouTube's built-in Test & Compare (3 variants, two weeks), send you a one-page readout, and route everything through your compliance review first. Nothing goes live without your sign-off.

Worth a two-week test on that video?

[Name]

[Site] | [City, State] | Reply "no" and I will not follow up.

Maximum 15 a day from one mailbox for the first 30 days. Move to the business domain in week four, once it is three weeks old and authentication passes. Follow up on day 5 and day 12 with a **new observation each time**, never a bump.

### The offer ladder

| Offer         | Price       | What it is                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A/B pack      | \$150 - 300 | Three titles, three thumbnails, YouTube's own Test & Compare configured in their Studio, and a one-page readout after two weeks. <b>This is your first dollar.</b> Only sell it to a channel averaging 1,000+ views on its last three uploads, with one inside 90 days. |
| Core retainer | \$800/mo    | The full monthly package. Two consolidated revision rounds; extras at \$200 - 250.                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Price step    | \$1,000/mo  | New clients only, and only after two proof points: a consultation booked through a tracked link, or a test win with a click-through lift.                                                                                                                               |

---

## SECTION 6

### The monthly cycle, once a client signs

| When        | What happens                                                                                                                                   | Who    |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 1st         | Send last month's memo. Invoice this month, in advance, by bank transfer.                                                                      | You    |
| by 5th      | Client records 45 to 60 minutes, <b>camera and screen as separate tracks</b> . Put that in the contract; a combined recording costs you hours. | Client |
| 6th - 8th   | Transcript and cleanup. Claude proposes three episodes, you choose.                                                                            | You    |
| 9th - 12th  | Cut and polish the long form, fix the Shorts, thumbnails, metadata.                                                                            | You    |
| 13th - 15th | Compliance package to their named reviewer with the approval form.                                                                             | You    |
| approval    | Expect <b>2 to 4 weeks</b> in months one and two while their reviewer builds a template. Five business days after that.                        | Client |
| then        | One episode each Tuesday. Shorts Thursday and Saturday. A test on every episode.                                                               | You    |
| 25th        | Send the brief for the next recording: one question, phrased the way a client would search for it.                                             | You    |

**Nothing is scheduled until written sign-off arrives.** Archive every approved version with its date and approver: that archive is also what supports the adviser's own record-keeping duty, and it is part of what you are selling.

---

## SECTION 7

### Decision gates - check these on the date, not when it feels right

| Gate           | Pass                                                             | If you miss it                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Day 30</b>  | 100+ touches, 3+ replies, one pack sold or three calls booked    | Under three replies: rewrite the first line, move half the volume to connection notes. Zero replies after 100 touches and two rewrites: stop sending and get three warm introductions. |
| <b>Day 60</b>  | Three A/B packs sold to channels that meet the recency rule      | One or two sold: extend three weeks, cut the pack to \$150, add a teardown video to every touch. <b>Zero after 200 touches: stop</b> and move the hours.                               |
| <b>Day 90</b>  | One retainer at \$800+ signed, or a signed start date            | An adjust gate, not a kill gate. Also check hours per client are at or below 22. Continue past it only with two live proposals or a verbal yes.                                        |
| <b>Day 120</b> | The kill gate                                                    | No retainer at \$800+ after 300 personalised touches: demote this and hand the hours over.                                                                                             |
| <b>Month 6</b> | Two clients, hours trending to 16, one attributable booking each | Two clients but hours over 20: stop selling, template the polish steps, then resume. One client and a churn: switch to a packaging-only offer at \$300 - 500.                          |

### Stop and do something else if either of these happens

**Hours per client are still above 22 at month six.** The economics do not work at \$800 and 22 hours. That is a demotion signal, not a reason to try harder.

**YouTube ships automatic clipping and AI titles for every creator** and two prospects name it as the reason they will not buy. Re-price to \$600 - 800 immediately; if that does not close inside 60 days, stop.

## SECTION 8

### Verify these before you spend anything

| What                                                       | Where                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Current price of every tool                                | At checkout. All figures here are second-hand.                                          |
| The Nevada exemption threshold                             | Nevada's published taxable wage base                                                    |
| Whether a prospect's channel has Advanced Features enabled | Ask on the call. You cannot see it from outside, so it cannot be part of list-building. |
| Your own hours on the two portfolio samples                | Your time log. This is the number the whole plan rests on.                              |

**One caveat on the evidence.** Every figure in this plan except the Nevada items came from search summaries rather than primary pages, because the research sessions could not reach them. The Nevada facts were fetched live and are sourced. Treat all of it as "start here and validate before you sign anything", not as a forecast.

Full detail, including the market case, the six production prompts, the risk register and every source, is in the project vault at [brain/reports/youtube-manager-expert-firms/](#).